# Practice workbook · Spotting the IV and the DV

Recognising which factor a study changes or compares (IV) and which outcome it measures (DV).

4 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 3 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-RM-01

# 1. Question 1 · part a · 1 mark

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part a only.

**1** Thomas recruited participants to investigate obedience to authority. The participants were asked to attend a university.

They were allocated to one of two conditions:

- Condition A: 30 participants were instructed to answer general knowledge questions in silence for 40 minutes by a man dressed in a uniform.
- Condition B: 30 participants were instructed to answer general knowledge questions in silence for 40 minutes by a man dressed in jeans and a t-shirt.

Thomas recorded how many participants obeyed the instruction to remain silent.

(a) Identify the dependent variable (DV) in Thomas' investigation.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Whether the man was wearing a uniform or jeans and a t-shirt.
- ☒ **B** The amount of time participants were given to answer the questions.
- ☒ **C** The number of participants who obeyed the man's instruction to remain silent.
- ☒ **D** The number of general knowledge questions participants were instructed to answer.

(b) Describe **one** participant variable that Thomas may have considered when conducting his investigation.

(2)

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## 1. Question 1 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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# 2. Question 2 · part a · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

**2** Winston investigated gender differences in pro-social and anti-social behaviour. He placed a mobile phone on a seat near the local police station and recorded the responses of male and female passers-by to the mobile phone.

(a) Name the independent variable (IV) for Winston's investigation.

**(1)**

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(b) The results for Winston's investigation are shown in **Table 2**.

| | Number of male passers-by | Number of female passers-by |
|---|---|---|
| Took the mobile phone to the police station | 3 | 7 |
| Walked away with the mobile phone | 8 | 8 |
| Walked past the mobile phone | 7 | 15 |

**Table 2**

Calculate how many participants were male as a fraction of all participants.

You must give your answer in the lowest form.

**(2)**

Males as a fraction of all participants .....

(c) Winston claims that females are more pro-social than males.

Give **one** way that the data in **Table 2** could support Winston's claim.

**(1)**

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**(Total for Question 2 = 4 marks)**

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## 2. Question 2 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 3. Question 5 · part a · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

**5** Cathy researched whether short-term memory improved when grouping was used for learning telephone numbers. She showed the participants 10 telephone numbers.

- Condition A learned whole telephone numbers, for example 01234567890
- Condition B learned grouped telephone numbers, for example 0123 4567 890

Each telephone number was shown for 15 seconds. Then, after a 30-second delay, participants were asked to write the telephone number down.

The results of Cathy's experiment are shown in **Table 3**.

| | Number of correctly recalled telephone numbers | Number of incorrectly recalled telephone numbers |
|---|---|---|
| **Condition A** | 3 | 7 |
| **Condition B** | 6 | 4 |

**Table 3**

(a) Identify the independent variable for Cathy's experiment.

**(1)**

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(b) Cathy concluded that grouping improves recall in short-term memory.

Give **one** way that the data in **Table 3** could support this conclusion.

**(1)**

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P 6 6 5 7 5 R A 0 8 4 8

## 3. Question 5 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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# 4. Question 1 · part a · 1 mark

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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**1** Gary conducted an experiment to test whether there was a difference in the ability of boys and girls to conserve number. He sampled 50 boys and 50 girls aged six years old.

Gary showed them the image in **Figure 1**.

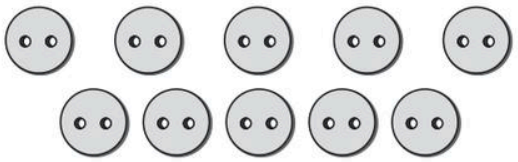


**Figure 1**

Gary asked each child to say whether the top row of buttons contained more, less, or the same number of buttons as the bottom row.

(a) Identify the independent variable in Gary's experiment.

(1)

- ☒ **A** age
- ☒ **B** gender
- ☒ **C** ability
- ☒ **D** conservation

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(b) Give **two** ways that Gary could ensure his experiment is ethical.

(2)

1 .....

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2 .....

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## 4. Question 1 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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